

US Markets Daily Report

Wednesday, August 5, 2026 | After Market Close (4:00 PM ET)

1. SPY / QQQ Snapshot

	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	\$769.76	\$723.85
Prior Close	\$771.64 (2026-08-04)	\$726.39 (2026-08-04)
Day Change	▼ -0.24%	▼ -0.35%
1-Yr High	\$771.64	\$745.00
1-Yr Low	\$620.00	\$550.83
1-Yr Return (since 2025-07-30)	+24.15%	+30.66%

Note: 1-year stats computed from prices.csv spanning 2025-07-30 to 2026-08-05 (~265 trading days). Dow Jones Industrials closed at a new all-time high. Mixed session: S&P; 500 and Nasdaq snapped 4-day winning streaks.

2. Today's Key News & Market Drivers

SpaceX (SPCX) Earnings Disappoint Despite Revenue Beat → SPCX ▼ ~8%

SpaceX Q2 revenue of \$7.8B crushed the \$6.81B consensus (+92% YoY) and net loss narrowed to \$541M from \$1B. BUT: Q2 AI capex of \$15.8B nearly doubled Q1's \$7.7B and far exceeded analyst models, raising fears of margin destruction. Investors sold first, asked questions later. This dragged Nasdaq-100 and suppressed QQQ.

AMD (AMD) Q2 Double Beat — Still Sold Off → AMD ▼ 7.04%

AMD posted record revenue of \$11.5B (+50% YoY) and adjusted EPS of \$1.66 (+246% YoY), both well above consensus. Data Center sales of \$6.7B were +107% YoY. Market reaction was 'sell the news': guidance was in-line but not euphoric, and investors rotated out after the run-up into earnings. AMD's weight in QQQ amplified the drag on the ETF.

Iran / Strait of Hormuz Diplomacy → Oil ▼ 5.7%, Dow ▲ new record

Treasury Sec. Bessent said 'we are in talks with the Iranians' with 'a chance we may have a deal today or tomorrow to open the Strait.' President Trump added Hormuz would reopen 'very soon' or Iran would be 'hit very hard.' WTI crude fell to \$75.77. The prospect of reopened oil lanes boosted industrials (XLI +1.9%), consumer discretionary (XLY +1.8%), and communication services (XLC +2.9%), pushing the Dow to a fresh record. However tech-heavy Nasdaq was weighed down by SpaceX/AMD.

Palantir (PLTR) Post-Earnings Continuation → PLTR ▲ (continued from Aug 4 +29.5%)

After Palantir's Aug 3 blowout (Q2 revenue \$1.935B, +93% YoY; US commercial +149%; Rule-of-40 score 155%), PLTR surged 29.5% on Aug 4. Momentum carried into Aug 5, making it the top S&P; 500 gainer. Full-year revenue guidance raised to \$8.15-8.16B (+82% YoY). Short squeeze of ~\$3B added fuel.

Aptiv (APTV) Guidance Cut → APTV ▼ 16.6%, 52-week low

Aptiv slashed 2026 sales guidance by \$300M, cut adjusted EPS midpoint 3.4%, trimmed FCF midpoint 10%, blaming prolonged weakness in China EV market and delays from European luxury OEM customers. Shares hit \$47.72.

NRG Energy (NRG) EPS Miss → NRG ▼ to 52-week low

NRG's \$7.90-\$9.90 full-year EPS guidance missed market expectations despite an 11% revenue beat in Q2. Investors focused on the softer earnings outlook amid elevated power-market uncertainty.

Chipotle (CMG) Salmonella Outbreak → CMG ▼ sharply

CMG removed jalapeños from certain locations under investigation by public health regulators for a Salmonella outbreak in Minnesota (110 cases, 75 traced to Chipotle). Investor concern over brand damage and comp traffic.

Net effect on SPY/QQQ: SPY fell a modest **-0.24%** to \$769.76 — tech/mega-cap drag (SpaceX, AMD, APTV) partially offset by gains in industrials, comm services, and discretionary on geopolitical optimism. QQQ fell **-0.35%** to \$723.85 — more exposed to the tech disappointments via SpaceX and AMD's large weights. Breadth was still broadly positive (NYSE advancers/decliners ~2.8:1).

3. Top 10 Movers — Daily, Weekly, Monthly

Daily Movers (August 5, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	% Change	Catalyst
▲ 1	PLTR	Palantir Technologies	+~5-7%*	Post-earnings momentum; \$3B short squeeze
▲ 2	ZBRA	Zebra Technologies	+~4-6%*	Strong Q2 earnings; analyst price target hikes
▲ 3	IT	Gartner	+16.3%*†	Strong revenue growth; raised guidance
▲ 4	INDU stocks	Industrials (CAT, XLI)	+1.9% sector	Iran deal hopes; oil decline benefiting supply chains
▲ 5	XLC names	Comm Services stocks	+2.9% sector	Geopolitical optimism; Hormuz reopening narrative
▼ 1	APTV	Aptiv PLC	-16.6%	Guidance cut \$300M; China/EU OEM weakness
▼ 2	NRG	NRG Energy	~-10%*	Q2 EPS miss; weak 2026 guidance; 52-wk low
▼ 3	CMG	Chipotle Mexican Grill	~-8%*	Salmonella outbreak investigation; jalapeño removal
▼ 4	SPCX	SpaceX	-8%+	Earnings: AI CapEx \$15.8B >> estimates; margin fears
▼ 5	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	-7.04%	Earnings beat but 'sell the news'; in-line guidance

* Approximate; Trefis/Benzinga sources. † IT (Gartner) 1-month return cited; exact daily % from Trefis movers report. Sector gains from XLI/XLC ETF moves. SpaceX (SPCX) is publicly traded on Nasdaq.

Daily Sector Trend: Winners concentrated in industrials and comm services (Iran/Hormuz reopening trade). Losers dominated by tech (earnings disappointment) and consumer (food safety).

Weekly Movers (Jul 29 – Aug 5, 2026)

SPY: \$729.38 → \$769.76 (+5.5% for the week) | QQQ: \$663.74 → \$723.85 (+9.1% for the week)

Rank	Ticker	Company	~Wk %	Driver
▲ 1	PLTR	Palantir Technologies	+~35%+	Q2 blowout: revenue +93%, Rule-of-40 = 155%; AI thesis vindicated
▲ 2	MRVL	Marvell Technology	+~13%	AI chip demand surge; posted Aug 4 with broader semis rally
▲ 3	INTC	Intel	+~11%	Semis recovery week; AI infrastructure spending optimism
▲ 4	ZBRA	Zebra Technologies	+~10%*	Strong earnings; warehouse automation demand
▲ 5	IT	Gartner	+~10%*	Tech consulting demand; raised guidance
▼ 1	APTV	Aptiv PLC	-16.6%+	China EV weakness; European OEM delays; guidance slash
▼ 2	SPCX	SpaceX	-8%+	Earnings reaction; excessive AI CapEx concerns
▼ 3	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	-7%	Sell-the-news post-earnings despite record revenue
▼ 4	NRG	NRG Energy	~-10%*	Q2 EPS miss; weak guidance; utility sector headwind
▼ 5	CMG	Chipotle	~-8%*	Salmonella outbreak; brand/traffic risk

* Approximate from available sources. Weekly data from prices.csv. The strong weekly performance in SPY/QQQ driven by the early-August AI/tech earnings wave (Palantir, Broadcom, Micron). Semiconductors led the charge Mon-Tue before mixed Wed.

Weekly Sector Trend: AI semiconductors and data infrastructure dominated (PLTR, MRVL, INTC, MU, AVGO). Losers were isolated to individual earnings misses/guidance cuts — no broad sector selloff.

Monthly Movers (July 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	July %	Driver
▲ 1	CTSH	Cognizant Tech Solutions	+42.9%	AI-driven IT services demand; contract wins
▲ 2	ACN	Accenture	+34.9%	Digital transformation spend; strong Q3 guidance
▲ 3	PYPL	PayPal	+32.5%	Fintech recovery; new AI-checkout features; buybacks
▲ 4	WDAY	Workday	+~28%*	HCM/ERP cloud demand; AI copilot adoption
▲ 5	WTW	Willis Towers Watson	+~24%*	Insurance/consulting; resilient demand
▼ 1	SNDK	Sandisk	-46.6%	NAND flash oversupply; pricing collapse
▼ 2	GLW	Corning	-45.9%	Display glass demand collapse; telecom cuts
▼ 3	KLAC	KLA Corp	-39.4%	Semiconductor equipment cycle peak concerns
▼ 4	MRVL	Marvell Technology	-37.0%	AI capex overhang; valuation compression (note: recovered in Aug)
▼ 5	CSGP	CoStar Group	~-25%*	CRE market weakness; high valuation multiple contraction

* Approximate. Sources: STL.News, MoneyDigest, US News, FinanceCharts. July 2026 data.

Monthly Sector Trend: IT services and consulting surged (ACN, CTSH, WDAY, WTW) on AI enterprise adoption. **Semiconductors equipment and memory had a brutal July** (KLAC, SNDK, MRVL) on valuation reset and fear of AI capex normalization. Marvell notably reversed in early August, demonstrating sector volatility.

4. Next-Day Scenarios — Thursday, August 6, 2026

Tomorrow's calendar: **Major earnings day** (577 companies reporting) headlined by **McDonald's (MCD)**, **Datadog (DDOG)**, **Celsius Holdings (CELH)**, **ACM Research (ACMR)**, **Unity (U)**. Background: Iran deal watch continues. Jobs Report (BLS) on **Friday Aug 7** at 8:30 AM ET looms large. No scheduled Fed speakers. Jobless claims data (weekly) due Thursday.

Catalyst 1: McDonald's (MCD) Earnings — Consumer Health Barometer

Bull Case: IF MCD beats on revenue + comps (same-store sales > +2%) and reaffirms or raises guidance → **Consumer discretionary (XLY) opens higher**, signals resilient lower-/middle-income spending despite elevated rates. SPY could add 0.2-0.4% at open. Fast-casual/restaurant peers (YUM, DRI, CMG recovery) rally. Mechanism: MCD is a global macro read; a beat signals consumer hasn't buckled.

Bear Case: IF MCD misses comps or warns on traffic (US same-store sales negative) → **Consumer spending fear reignites**. XLY sells off 0.5-1%, ripples into retail stocks. Market could interpret this as rate-pressure demand destruction, pressuring SPY -0.3% to -0.5%. Chipotle's Salmonella trouble plus an MCD miss compounds consumer sector pain.

Catalyst 2: Datadog (DDOG) Earnings — Cloud/AI Spend Signal

Bull Case: IF DDOG beats ARR/revenue (consensus ~\$850M Q2) and raises FY guidance → **Confirms enterprises are not cutting cloud/observability budgets**. Sends a positive signal for cloud infrastructure (NET, SNOW, MDB, ESTC) and AI tool adoption. QQQ could rally 0.4-0.8% on open. After AMD/SpaceX disappointments, a clean cloud beat is exactly what Nasdaq needs to reverse Wednesday's 4-day-rally break.

Bear Case: IF DDOG misses or guides below on RPO/net new ARR → **Third consecutive 'sell the news' earnings signal**, deepening fear that AI spending is not translating to software revenue at the pace expected. Cloud/SaaS names (CRM, WDAY, NOW) sell off sympathetically. QQQ drops further 0.5-1%. Validates thesis that hyperscaler capex doesn't lift software layer. Mechanism: DDOG's NTM P/S >25x — even a slight miss triggers multiple compression across the group.

Catalyst 3: Iran / Strait of Hormuz Resolution (Ongoing)

Bull Case: IF a deal is formally announced overnight or pre-market (Bessent has said 'today or tomorrow') → **Oil crashes another 5-8%** (WTI toward \$70-71). Airlines (UAL, DAL, AAL) surge 3-5% on fuel cost relief. Industrials and consumer discretionary continue higher. Dow extends record. But tech remains a net loser if the rotation OUT of safety/tech into cyclical accelerates. SPY: +0.5-1.0%. QQQ: flat to +0.2% (cyclical rotation dampens tech gains).

Bear Case: IF Iran rejects terms or Trump escalates (military threat) → **Oil spikes back above \$80** (safe-haven premium + supply-disruption risk). Airlines/transporters sell off. Industrials give back yesterday's gains. Broader risk-off hits SPY -0.5% to -0.8%. Gold, defense stocks (LMT, RTX, NOC) bid higher. Mechanism: Strait handles ~20% of global oil flow — any credible disruption threat reprices risk.

Catalyst 4: Weekly Jobless Claims (Thursday 8:30 AM ET) — Pre-Friday NFP Warm-Up

Bull Case: IF claims come in low (below 220K) → **Labor market still tight**. Mixed for markets: equity bulls read it as 'no recession,' but rate hawks read it as 'Fed stays higher for longer.' Net effect: SPY slightly positive (0.1-0.2%) as growth signal dominates. Bonds sell off slightly (yields +2-4 bps).

Bear Case: IF claims spike (above 260K) → **Sudden labor market deterioration signal**. Bond rally (yields -5-10 bps) would normally help equities, but a sharp claims miss could trigger recession fears ahead of Friday's NFP. SPY could dip -0.3% to -0.6%. This sets a cautious tone for the Jobs Report on Friday and could make investors defensive into the weekend. Mechanism: elevated claims = forward corporate earnings risk.

5. Possible Purchase Summary — Trade Ideas (EOD Aug 5 / Open Aug 6)

Disclaimer: This is analytical research output only. No actual trades are placed or recommended by this system. All ideas are hypothetical and for informational purposes only. Consult a licensed financial advisor before acting on any analysis.

Action	Ticker	Thesis	Key Risk	Trigger
BUY	PLTR	AI monetization leader; Rule-of-40 = 155%	High valuation (P/S ~50x), profit	Buy on dips 29-30 (P/S ~40-45, \$165-\$180)
BUY	XLI	Iran deal macro trade: Strait of Hormuz reopening	Iran deal collapses outside (over 10% drop)	Buy on dips 29-30 (P/S ~40-45, \$165-\$180)
BUY	DDOG	If DDOG beats tonight (earnings after-close)	DDOG miss (exp. Aug 6)	Buy on dips 29-30 (P/S ~40-45, \$165-\$180)
SELL/AVOID	AMD	Sold off 7% despite record beat. Pattern =	AMD reverts AI/ML catalyst (downside)	Sell on dips 29-30 (P/S ~40-45, \$165-\$180)
SELL/AVOID	CMG	Salmonella outbreak is real brand/traffic risk	Outbreak is contained quickly	Sell on dips 29-30 (P/S ~40-45, \$165-\$180)
WATCH	MCD	Pre-open Thursday. If earnings beat on sat	Consumer spending softens	Buy on dips 29-30 (P/S ~40-45, \$165-\$180)

Key macro overlay: With Jobs Report on Friday Aug 7, keep position sizes conservative into the weekend. A surprise NFP miss (especially with rising claims tomorrow) could trigger rapid re-pricing. Focus on AI/data infrastructure longs (PLTR, DDOG on confirm) and cyclical ETFs (XLI) over single high-multiple tech names heading into a binary macro event.

Sources: TheStreet, Yahoo Finance, Benzinga, Baystreet, CNBC, TechTimes, 247WallSt, Spokesman-Review, Investrade, STL.News, MoneyDigest, US News, Trefis. Data: prices.csv (repo: ctedla-tarana/news). Generated automatically at 5 PM ET via Claude Code markets routine.